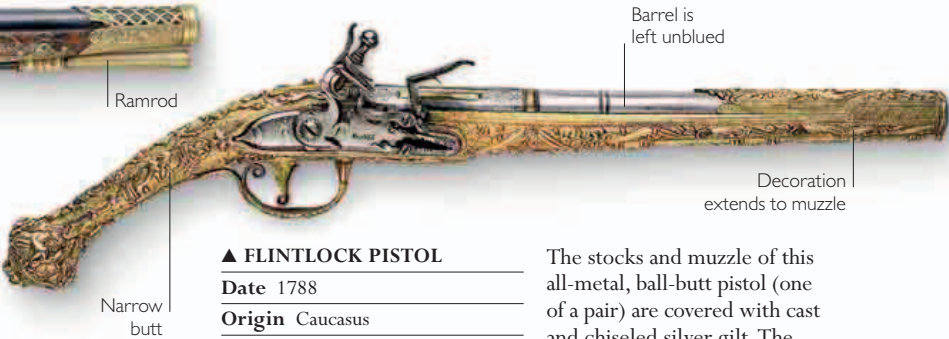




▲ FLINTLOCK PISTOL

Date Late 18th century
Origin Turkey
Barrel 12½in (31.75cm)
Caliber .62in (15.7mm)

A pistol such as this—stocked all the way to the muzzle, with its woodwork copiously inlaid and its lock, barrel, and trigger guard decorated with silver and gold—would have graced many arms cabinets in the Ottoman world. The flintlock firing this weapon appears to be of European origin.



▲ FLINTLOCK PISTOL

Date 1788
Origin Caucasus
Barrel 12in (30.5cm)
Caliber .60in (15.2mm)

The stocks and muzzle of this all-metal, ball-butt pistol (one of a pair) are covered with cast and chiseled silver gilt. The lock plate is inscribed “Rossi,” the maker’s name, suggesting that the lock, at least, was imported from Italy.



▲ FLINTLOCK BLUNDERBUSS

Date Late 18th century
Origin Turkey
Barrel 17in (43.18cm)
Caliber 1.5in (38.1mm) (at muzzle)

Ornate, even by Ottoman Empire standards, this silver-gilt blunderbuss carbine was most likely made as a presentation piece. Upon its lock plate is the inscription “London warranted,” which suggests that the lock is a copy of an English flintlock.



▲ MIQUELET LOCK RIFLE

Date Late 18th century
Origin Turkey
Barrel 32in (81.3cm)
Caliber .60in (15.2mm)

This rifle is of classic Turkish form. Its stock has the typical pentagonal-section butt, and fine inlaid decoration incorporating panels of metal wire and colored and natural ivory. The rifled “Damascus” barrel (see p.47) has a marked grain pattern and a tall aperture rear sight. The lock is decorated with gold and panels of coral.



▲ BALKAN MIQUELET TÜFENK

Date Early 19th century
Origin Turkey
Barrel 36in (91.4cm)
Caliber .55in (13.9mm)

This piece is reminiscent of Indian muskets. The stock is entirely covered in ivory and further embellished with inlays of precious stones and brass. The miquelet lock, common in Spain and Italy, is thought to have made its way to the Ottoman Empire via Africa.